



Jesse Marlow

MARKETING LEAD · EVERGREEN & PINE CO.

“Can make a fruit basket look like a movie poster.”



FOR JESSE MARLOW’S EYES ONLY

Do not show these pages to anyone, including the host.

WHO YOU ARE (EVERYONE KNOWS THIS)

You are the Marketing Lead of Evergreen & Pine Co. You run the website, the catalog and every product photo shoot. If a gift basket looks irresistible online, that’s your work.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Bart Pringle:** presented this year’s holiday campaign with you in November.
- **Skyler Moss:** the intern who loves borrowing your camera.
- **Parker Lane:** keeps your website online (most days).



YOUR PARTY ACCESSORY

A Santa hat and a camera strap around your neck. No full costume needed.

HOW THIS BOOKLET WORKS

1. Before the party, read pages 1 and 2 alone.
2. Page 3 holds Rounds 1 and 2. Fold it so only Round 1 shows; open Round 2 only when called.
3. Page 4 is Round 3 and your notes: keep it shut until Round 3.
4. You may help a team, but never vote for yourself.

THE CASE (EVERYONE KNOWS THIS)

At 4:15 pm Bart Pringle, VP of Sales, opened a Secret Santa gift: a tin of peppermint fudge. About twenty minutes later Bart collapsed. Every gift had waited on the side-hallway table, and ten people are suspects.

YOUR EVENING AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive wearing your accessory and name tag.
2. Detective Holloway reads Script 1.
3. Three Rounds: reveal, ask, mission.
4. Ballots, then the big reveal.

PAGE 1	PAGE 2	PAGE 3 · ROUND 1	PAGE 3 · ROUND 2	PAGE 4 · ROUND 3
Who you are Public facts	Your secret Story & goal	Tonight	New twists	Final answers + Notes



You are innocent. You did not harm Bart, but you do have something to hide.



Your private background

KEEP IT QUIET

YOUR STORY

Five years ago you joined a three-person marketing team. This year you created the Pinecone Post campaign, a tiny gift basket with a handwritten note that customers send to neighbors, and it became the company's best seller.

YOUR SECRET: DO NOT REVEAL IT UNTIL A ROUND TELLS YOU TO

Friday morning you found Bart's slides for Monday's board meeting on the shared drive. Pinecone Post was in them with Bart's name on it, not yours. You planned to show Walt your original files after the holidays. Also: this morning you bought a box of peppermint fudge from Snowcap Sweets as a photo-shoot prop. That looks bad now.

WHERE YOU WERE AT 3:35–3:50 PM

During the toast you stood near the front of the main hall filming Walt's speech on your phone. Skyler Moss borrowed your camera to take the 3:42 pm group photo, and you are in it.

YOUR GOAL TONIGHT

Keep the Pinecone Post story to yourself until Round 3, clear up the fudge misunderstanding, and help the teams solve the case.

GUESTS MAY ASK YOU

- **G6: "What did you photograph for the website this morning?"** "Cocoa, gingerbread and peppermint fudge from Snowcap Sweets. The photos look gorgeous."
- **G8: "What happened to the fudge from your photo shoot?"** "The warehouse team ate it at lunch. The empty white Snowcap box is in the studio bin."
- **G15: "Whose idea was the Pinecone Post campaign?"** Before Round 3: "It was a team effort." From Round 3: "Mine. Bart put Bart's own name on it."
- **G19: "Who is in your welcome-toast photo?"** "Skyler took it on my camera. I'll walk you through it once it's on the evidence table."

How to play this booklet: open each Round (page 3: Rounds 1–2, page 4: Round 3) only when Detective Holloway calls it.

BEFORE THE PARTY, CHECK OFF

- ☐ I know my alibi for 3:35–3:50 pm by heart.
- ☐ I have my party accessory ready.
- ☐ I have NOT peeked at pages 3–4.

NOTES BEFORE THE PARTY

Rounds 1 & 2

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❄ Round 1



Read only when Detective Holloway starts Round 1

REVEAL

- You spent the morning shooting holiday desserts for the website: cocoa, gingerbread and a box of peppermint fudge from Snowcap Sweets.
- You lent your camera to Skyler Moss, the intern, for the welcome-toast group photo.
- During the toast you stood near the front, filming Walt Evergreen's speech on your phone.

ASK

Ask **Avery Quill**: "Why was the gift table in the dim side hallway instead of the main hall?"

MISSION

Arrange two people into a "holiday catalog" pose and announce the photo title out loud.

IF ACCUSED

"My fudge came from Snowcap Sweets, in a white box. Check what Bart's fudge came in."

✂ **Fold here.** Keep Round 2 folded under until Detective Holloway calls **Round 2**.

❄ Round 2



Read only when Detective Holloway starts Round 2

REVEAL

- Your photo-shoot fudge was eaten by the warehouse team at lunch. The empty white Snowcap box is in the studio bin.
- The 3:42 pm toast photo was taken on your camera. You can confirm everyone it shows.
- Last week Bart asked you to send over “all your campaign files.” You thought it was for a budget review.

ASK

Ask **Kendall Brooks**: "Has Bart ever taken credit for your work?"

MISSION

Find a quest-card holder and trade one fact for one fact.

IF ACCUSED

"Look at the toast photo. I'm right there at the front, phone in hand."

NOTES: WHO SAID WHAT?

Round 3

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 Stop. Keep this page folded shut until Detective Holloway calls **Round 3**.

❄ Round 3



Read only when Detective Holloway starts Round 3

REVEAL

- Admit your secret: Bart's board slides put Bart's name on your Pinecone Post campaign. You were upset and planned to show Walt your original files.
- In your phone video of the toast, three people are missing: Rowan Pike, Parker Lane and the caterer, Drew Calder.
- Snowcap Sweets packs fudge in white boxes. Bart's fudge came in a peppermint-striped tin, so it wasn't yours.

ASK

Ask **Parker Lane**: "Where were you during the toast?"

MISSION

Help one team put the evidence in time order on their timeline.

IF ACCUSED

"Losing credit made me want to win, not to hurt anyone. I have the files to prove the idea was mine."

Notes

SUSPECT QUICK LIST (PUBLIC)

Team Alpha		Team Beta	
Name	Role	Name	Role
Avery Quill	Office Manager	Emerson Gray	HR Director
Rowan Pike	Finance Lead	Skyler Moss	Intern
Jesse Marlow	Marketing Lead	Drew Calder	Caterer
Kendall Brooks	Top Sales Rep	Reese Whitfield	Rival Company Rep
Parker Lane	IT Support	Finley Dale	Founder's Assistant